

Ricard Gardella Garcia



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<https://github.com/ricardgardella>

Languages

Spanish (Native)
Catalan (Native)
English (C1)

Programming Languages

Java, GO, Python, R, Scala,
Erlang, Javascript, SAPUI5, C++,
C, PL/SQL, Bash Scripting

AI/ML Frameworks

ADK, Langgraph, Copilot AI
Studio, PyTorch, TensorFlow,
Scikit-learn

Databases

Document-based, Graph-based,
Relational, Cache-based

Cybersecurity Tools

Pentesting tools, Red-teaming
frameworks, NIST-compliant
practices

Data & Cloud Technologies

AWS, Google Cloud Platform,
Azure, Spark, Airflow, DBT, Kafka,
Terraform, Kubernetes, Apache
NiFi, Debezium, Tableau,
Superset, PowerBI, A/B Testing,
Git, Docker, Linux, LaTeX

Software/Data Engineer & AI/Cyber Specialist

Summary

Bachelor's in Computer Engineering and Master's in Research and Innovation in Informatics (AI) from Universitat Politècnica de Catalunya (UPC). Expert in building scalable data pipelines, AI-driven solutions, and cybersecurity platforms, with a focus on emerging trends such as AI-integrated threat detection, real-time data processing, and AI deployments. Key skills include data engineering, machine learning, cybersecurity, and team leadership. Passionate about leveraging technology for disruptive impact, solving complex problems in AI, data governance, and cybersecurity. Balancing technical skills with high-level communication, I constantly seek to solve complex problems and guide change using cutting-edge technologies.

Experience

11/2024–Present **Zynap**

Remote

Lead AI Engineer, Cybersecurity

Led creation of autonomous AI agents that dynamically build & orchestrate complex cybersecurity workflows for proactive threat prediction, detection and neutralization in an AI-powered SaaS platform. Refactored critical codebases for superior efficiency, maintainability & security; achieved 67.5% performance boost by migrating to Elasticsearch (slashing query times vs MongoDB) and engineered high-scale ingestion platform handling 1B+ records/month. Deployed secure on-premise LLM models to process highly sensitive data locally, enabling powerful generative AI capabilities while fully preserving confidentiality and compliance.

Main: Python, SQL, Terraform, AWS, Airflow, Cybersecurity

Secondary: Pentesting, Red-teaming

Other: Scrum, Team Management, Tech Lead

02/2023–11/2024 **Bitpanda**

Hybrid - Barcelona

Data Engineer

Pioneered AI initiatives, including ML models for data enrichment, enabling real-time insights for 50+ ingestion jobs. Implemented DBT for four teams, halving project timelines and mentoring 3+ members plus intern. Enhanced data lake security and observability, supporting blockchain/Web3 compliance.

Main: Python, SQL, Snowflake, AWS, Astronomer, Airflow

Secondary: Kafka, Terraform, Debezium, DBT

Other: Web3, Blockchain, Agile, Scrum

08/2022–02/2023 **Inditex**

Remote

Data Engineer / Tech Lead

Built +50 data objects with millions of records for stakeholder decisions, impacting +5 teams and incorporated ML for forecasting. Improved CI/CD pipelines reducing deployment time and cost by 20%. Coached 4 engineers, ensuring agile delivery and data privacy standards.

Main: Python, SQL, Snowflake, Azure

Secondary: Kafka, MongoDB

Other: Tech Lead, Agile, Scrum

01/2021–07/2022	Goin <i>Data Engineer</i> Fintech app with 500K+ users. Scaled data-platform from 0 to hero. Created +50 pipelines, data models and dashboards. Managed real-time data. Created specific microservices for AI. Optimized cost-effectiveness amid growth, focusing on secure data exploitation. Main: Python, Google Cloud, Airflow, SQL, DataStudio Secondary: A/B Testing, MongoDB, ML, Docker, Kubernetes, Typescript, DeFi, Blockchain Other: Agile	Barcelona, ES
09/2019–01/2021	Delivery Mates <i>Head of Data</i> Led data department, architecting solutions from scratch with CTO. Coached 2-3 developers, delivering dashboards and pipelines for business insights. Main: Python, SQL, Google Cloud, Superset, Tableau, Airflow Secondary: MongoDB, React, Ruby Other: Agile, Task/Team Management	London, UK
07/2019–02/2020	Reby <i>Data Scientist / Data Engineer</i> Developed ML models for optimization, integrated with cloud pipelines. Main: Python, SQL, Google Cloud, Airflow, ML Secondary: MongoDB, DataStudio Other: Agile, Management	Barcelona, Spain
02/2018–07/2019	inLab FIB <i>Data Scientist / Data Engineer</i> Contributed to 18M€ EU project on travel forecasting with neural networks; basis for master's thesis. Main: Python, SQL, Neural Networks, ML Secondary: CPLEX, Docker	Barcelona, Spain

Education

2017–2019	M.Sc. in Innovation and Research in Informatics (MIRI), Data Science. Thesis: Travel time forecasting using probe vehicle data on freeways	UPC
2013–2017	Bachelor's degree in computer engineering Thesis: Machine Learning with H2o and R	UPC

Awards & Certificates

2020	HackCorona: Fraunhofer Institute Prize Developed AI chatbot for DIY ventilators in Data Natives hackathon, aiding engineers during COVID crisis.	
2018	Best Data Science project at the HackEPS 2018 Won for ML solution in BonÀrea retail challenge.	
2016	Certificate of Advanced English by Cambridge Assessment English	